Flourish
LEGAL WELL-BEING

Asking for Help as a Parent: The DESC Method

Every parent faces moments when they need support, whether it's from a partner, family, or community.

The DESC method (created by Gordon Bower, Ph.D., and Sharon Bower, M.A.) can help you ask for that support clearly and without conflict.

D	**Describe**	State the situation clearly and without emotion.	**Example:** "I've been handling all the bedtime routines this week."
E	**Express**	Share how you feel using "I" statements.	**Example:** "I'm feeling overwhelmed and exhausted."
S	**Specify**	Say exactly what you need from the other person.	**Example:** "I need your help with bedtime tonight and tomorrow."
C	**Consequence**	Explain what will happen if your need is or isn't met.	**Example:** "If you can do this, I'll have more energy to help with the morning routine. If not, I'm worried about burning out."